Assembly instructions

Overview

MID.1 and MID.1.RIG share the same assembly process except switch installation. Variant-specific instructions are noted in Steps 2–3. Kit includes nearly all tools and fasteners needed; gather additional items below before starting.

Additional things you'll need

- Pliers
- Plate-mounted stabilizers
- MX switches
- Keycaps
- Soldering iron + solder (MID.1.RIG only)

Work surface

Place a desk mat, cloth, or towel beneath parts to protect case surfaces during assembly.

Installing fasteners

Do not overtighten; firm, moderate torque is sufficient.

Fastener thread paste

Optional. Apply a tiny amount to screw threads to reduce friction and help prevent seizing. Run screw in and out once to distribute.

Drawing scale

Tools and fasteners below shown at 1:1 scale. Compare directly to identify correct part for each step.

Fasteners

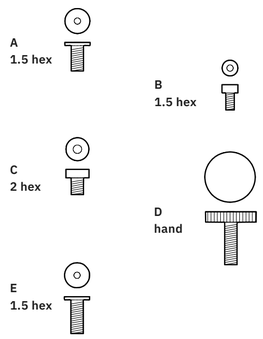
A Light box screws (×2)
Tighten with included 1.5 mm hex key

B Lighting module diffuser screws (×2)
Tighten with included 1.5 mm hex key

C Daughterboard screws (×2)
Tighten with included 2 mm hex key

D PCB thumbscrews (×4)
Tighten by hand

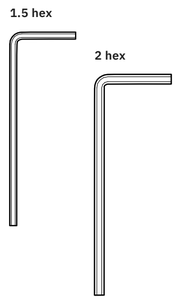
E Case screws (×4)
Tighten with included 1.5 mm hex key



Tools

F 1.5 mm hex key

G 2 mm hex key



Other components

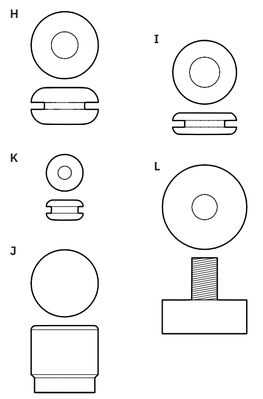
H PCB gaskets (×4)
Seat in fingers of PCB mounting points

I Case feet (×4)
Install by squeezing partially into hole, then pulling through from other side

J Rotary encoder knobs (×2)
Tighten with included 1.5 mm hex key

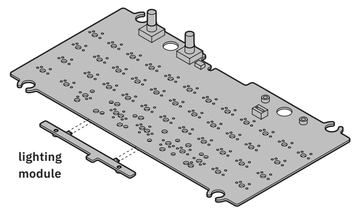
K Reset button gasket (×1)
Install by squeezing partially into hole, then pulling through from other side

L Riser feet (×2)
Install by threading into large sockets on bottom of case



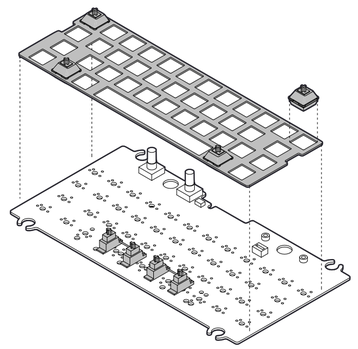
1

Break lighting module from main PCB by bending both attachment tabs simultaneously. Remove remaining tab stubs with pliers.



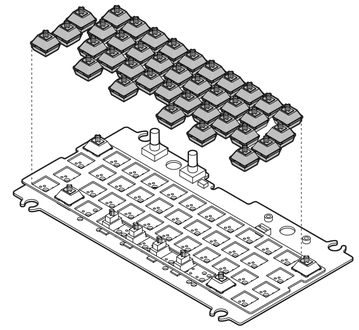
2

Install plate-mounted stabilizers for chosen bottom-row layout. Install four switches near plate corners to locate PCB. Seat in hotswap sockets (MID.1); solder to hold alignment (MID.1.RIG). With corner-blocker top + staggered PCB, use nearest active bottom-row positions instead of blocked corners.



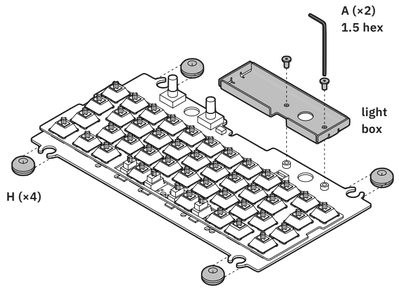
3

Install remaining switches for chosen layout. MID.1.RIG: solder switches.



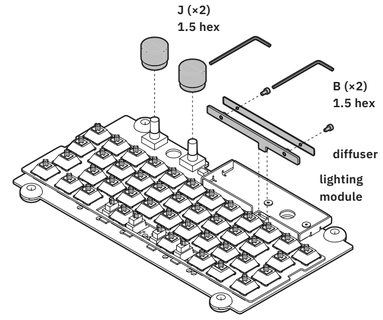
4

Seat PCB grommets between fingers of PCB mounting points. Install light box with screws.



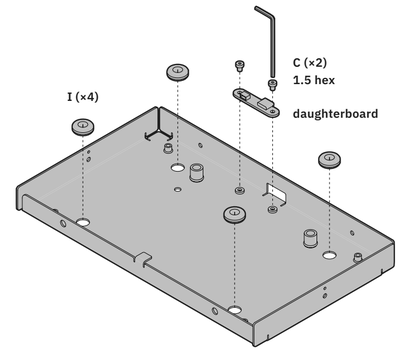
5

Install diffuser on lighting module with screws. Insert lighting module + diffuser into connector inside light box, diffuser facing rear of keyboard. Install encoder knobs; tighten side set screws against flat faces of stems.



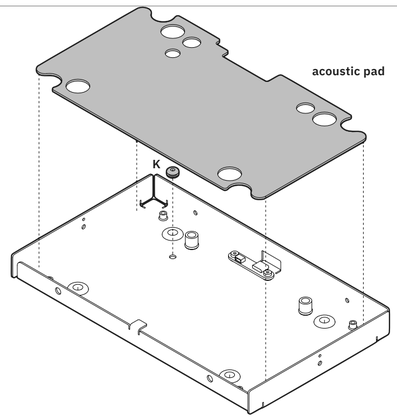
6

Install feet by pressing partially through bottom-case holes, then pulling through from opposite side. Install daughterboard with screws.



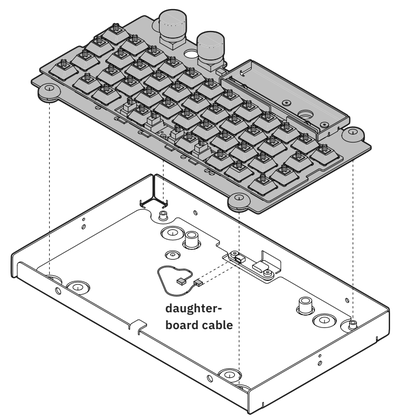
7

Install reset-button grommet using same method as feet. Place optional acoustic pad in bottom case.



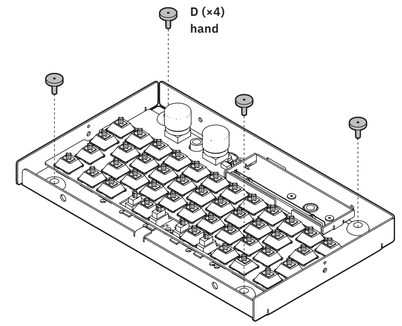
8

Connect black Molex end of daughterboard cable to daughterboard. Install PCB in bottom case.



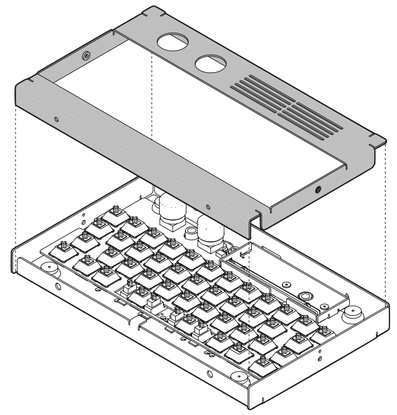
9

Connect white JST end of daughterboard cable to PCB. Secure PCB with thumbscrews, tightening onto PCB gaskets.



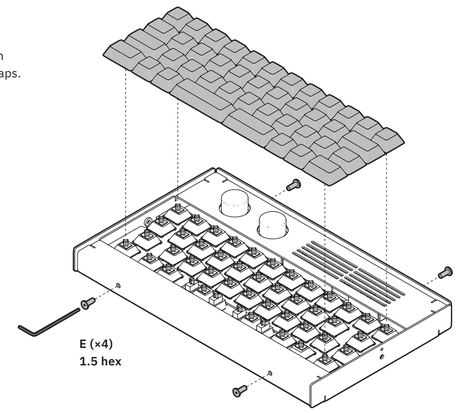
10

Lower chosen top case onto bottom case, guiding knob holes over knobs. Front of top case should overlap bottom case.



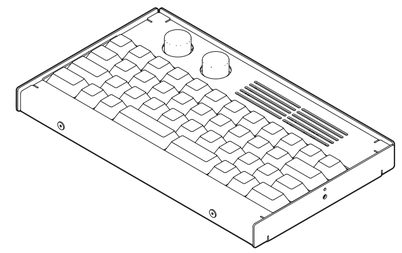
11

Secure top case with screws. Install keycaps.



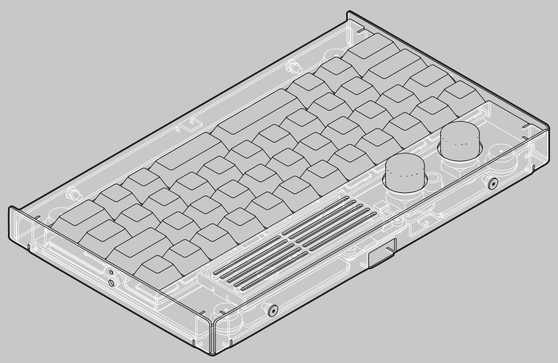
12

Nice work! Your MID.1 is ready to go!



MID.1

Manual Input Device
Owner's Manual
A.Okay!



In the box

- Top case
- Bottom case
- Plate
- PCB + lighting module
- Light box
- Lighting module diffuser
- PCB gaskets
- Daughterboard + cable
- Feet
- Riser feet
- Rotary encoder knobs
- Acoustic pad
- Case screws
- PCB screws
- Lighting module diffuser screws
- Daughterboard screws
- 1.5 mm hex key
- 2 mm hex key

Specifications

Materials	
Case + plate	Powder-coated stainless steel
Acoustic pad	100% wool felt
Hardware	Stainless steel
Feet + gaskets	Synthetic rubber
Dimensions	
Size (W × D × H)	235 × 141 × 24 mm 9-1/4 × 5-9/16 × 1 in
Height (with knobs)	31 mm | 1-3/16 in
Typing angle	0° / 4°
Weight	890 g | 2.0 lb
PCB thickness	1.6 mm

Setup

Assembly

See back for assembly instructions.

Initial plug-in

The lighting module will illuminate with an orange glow. The keyboard is ready to work with standard firmware already installed.

Reset button

Located on bottom of PCB. To access it without disassembly, insert one of the included hex keys through the red grommet on bottom of case; press gently.

Typing angle adjustment

Kit includes two optional riser feet for a 4-degree typing angle. To install, screw into large sockets on the underside of the case.

Keymap customization

VIA

Remap keys, layers, and encoders.

1 Open VIA.
2 Connect MID.1. It should appear automatically.
3 Make changes; export configuration.

If MID.1 isn't recognized, load MID.1 VIA definition (.json) and retry.

- aokay.cool/resources

QMK

For firmware-level customization.

To flash, enter bootloader mode using the reset button on PCB underside.

Repository:

- github.com/qmk/qmk_firmware/tree/master/keyboards/aokay

Care

General care

MID.1 is designed for daily use and long-term maintenance. Powder-coated surfaces are durable but not scratch-proof; avoid sharp or abrasive materials.

Keycap removal

With metal keycap pullers, use care or remove top case to avoid scratching.

Loose screws

Metallic ping while typing may indicate a loose screw. Check exterior case screws with the appropriate hex key. If ping persists, open case and check PCB thumb screws.

Cleaning

Exterior: Wipe with a soft, dry cloth. For grime, use a damp cloth with mild soap if necessary; dry immediately.

Inside case: Unplug before opening. Remove dust with compressed air or soft brush. Avoid liquids.

Service and repairs

Standard components and mechanical fasteners throughout; no adhesives. Worn parts can be replaced by hand or with common tools. For troubleshoot or repair guidance:

hello@aokay.cool

Replacement parts

Feet, screws, and other replacement parts are available at aokay.cool when possible.

Disposal

Parts and materials were selected in part for recyclability. Recycle where possible.

Notes

Support

hello@aokay.cool
aokay.cool

Warranty

1-year limited warranty covering manufacturing defects from date of receipt. Excludes misuse, modification, accidents, and normal wear.

Made by A.Okay! in Seattle, USA

Product design, PCB design, engineering, packaging design, assembly, inspection

With contributions from:

Robert Kleeman	Firmware Seattle, USA
PCBWay	PCB fabrication Shenzhen, China
SendCutSend	Sheet metal fabrication Reno, USA
Arka	Packaging fabrication San Francisco, USA
Girlie Press	Printing Seattle, USA

Personal thanks

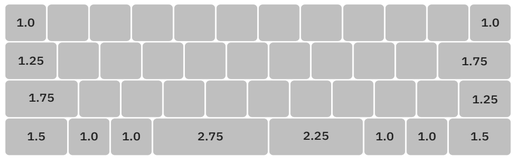
Interest check respondents — early signal and candid feedback

Seattle keyboard community — encouragement, meetups, and inclusiveness

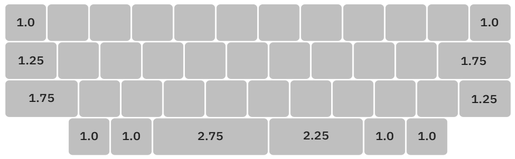
flo — encouragement and sharp design feedback, from the big idea to this poster

MID.1 key layout options

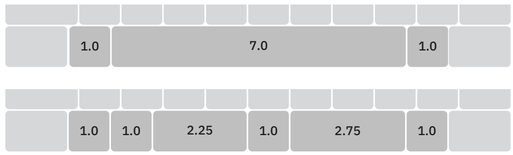
Standard: 42 keys, double-split spacebar



Corner-blocker: removes bottom 1.50u keys

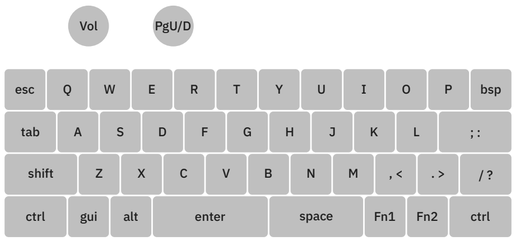


Alternate spacebars: 7.00u or triple-split

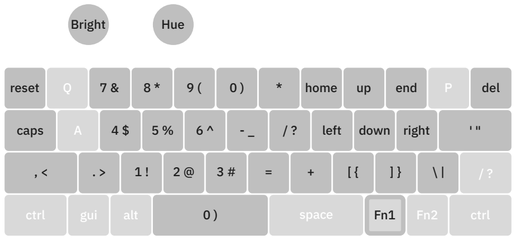


MID.1 default keymap

Default keymap



Hold Fn1: numpad + navigation + lighting

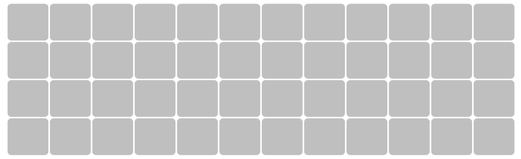


Hold Fn2: additional lighting

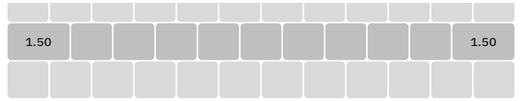


MID.1.RIG key layout options

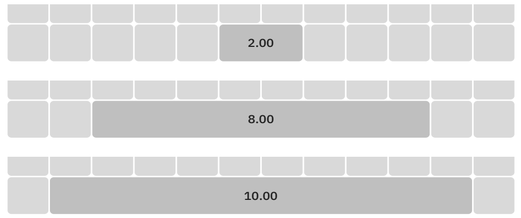
Standard: 48-key Rectilinear Input Grid



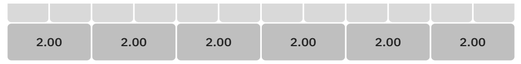
Alpha stagger: staggered Z row



Alternate spacebars: 2u, 8u, or 10u

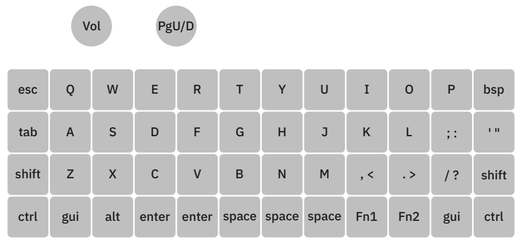


Alternate bottom row: full 2u

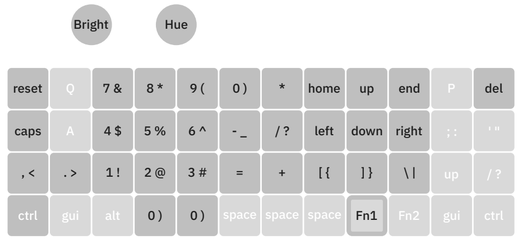


MID.1.RIG default keymap

Default keymap: 48-key Rectilinear Input Grid



Hold Fn1: numpad + navigation + lighting



Hold Fn2: additional lighting

